

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

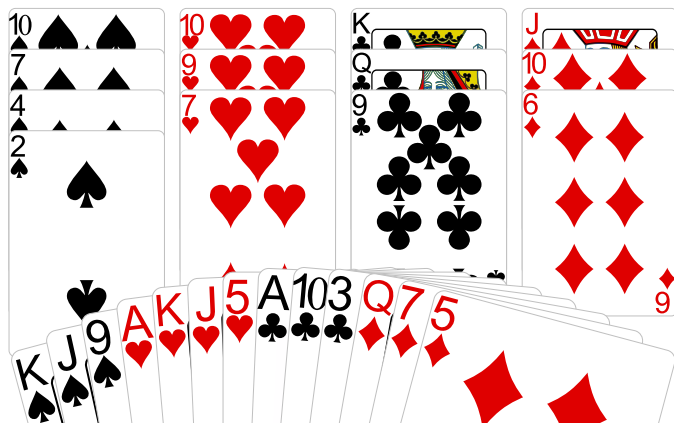
Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

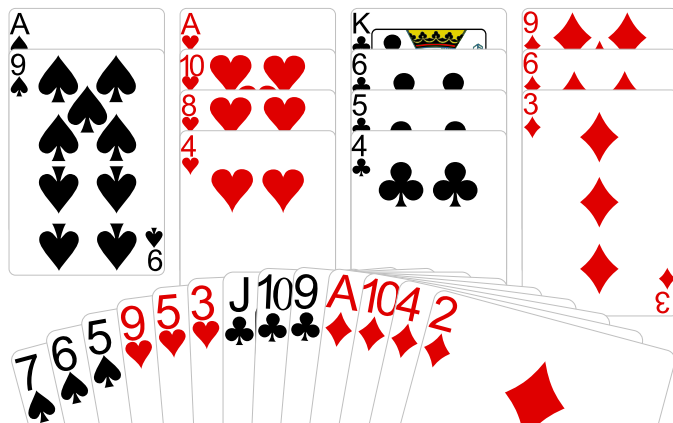
- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 1♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



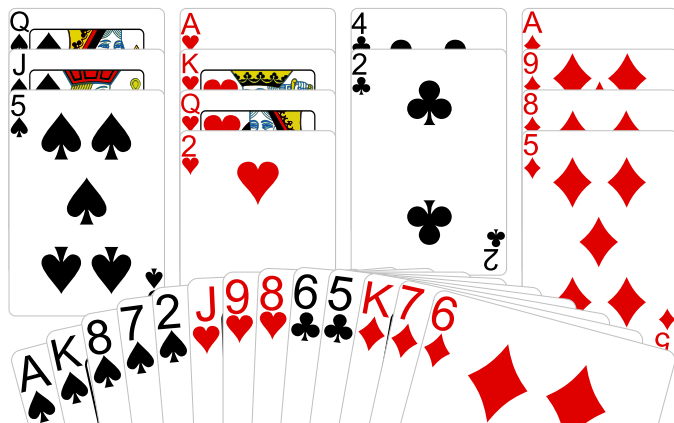
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 1♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



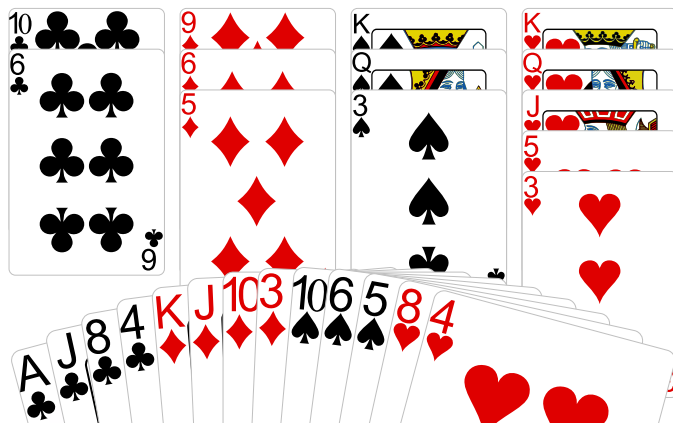
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 1NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1♠

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 1♠

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: West

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 6
♥ Q 8 6 3
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ 8 5

♠ K J 9
♥ A K J 5
♦ Q 7 5
♣ A T 3



♠ A 5 3
♥ 4 2
♦ A K 2
♣ J 7 6 4 2

♠ T 7 4 2
♥ T 9 7
♦ J T 6
♣ K Q 9

EAST has 13 points but she has to pass. She cannot Double without support for ♥s. She cannot bid 1NT without 2 more points. She cannot overcall 2♣ with a terrible suit like that.

And WEST of course must also pass.

West

North
1♠

East

South

All Pass

1♠ by North

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9
♥ A T 8 4
♦ 9 6 3
♣ K 6 5 4

♠ T 3

♥ K J 7 6

♦ K J 5

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ 7 6 5

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A T 4 2

♣ J T 9

♠ K Q J 8 4 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ 8 3

SOUTH obviously has to pass when EAST opens 1♠.

NORTH has a reasonable Takeout Double. She hopes SOUTH will name a suit and they can just play a partscore.

You should almost always bid when partner makes a Takeout Double. Almost always. This is the one time when you don't. SOUTH's ♠ are so good that he passes, converting the Takeout Double into a Penalty Double.

West	North	East	South
		1♠	Pass
Pass	Dbl		
All Pass			
1♠ by East			

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 9 4
♥ T 7 6
♦ J T 4
♣ A J T 7

♠ Q J 5

♥ A K Q 2

♦ A 9 8 5

♣ 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 3

♥ 5 4 3

♦ Q 3 2

♣ K Q 9 8 3

♠ A K 8 7 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ K 7 6

♣ 6 5

SOUTH has a normal overcall of 1 ♠.

NORTH has a really good hand, but he doesn't have to worry about missing a slam since SOUTH will not have more than 16 points. So he just bids what he thinks SOUTH can make, 4 ♠.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ T 6 5
♥ 8 4
♦ K J T 3
♣ A J 8 4

♠ J 7 4 2

♥ A T 9

♦ 7 4 2

♣ K 9 3



♠ K Q 3
♥ K Q J 5 3
♦ 9 6 5
♣ T 6

♠ A 9 8

♥ 7 6 2

♦ A Q 8

♣ Q 7 5 2

EAST has 12 points and a good enough suit to overcall 1 ♥.

WEST has 9 points with a good ♦ stopper. She bids 1NT.

EAST has nothing more to say, and lets WEST play 1NT.

West

North

East

South

1 ♦

1 ♥

Pass

1NT

All Pass

1NT by West